I told Nancy's father, Loyal Davis, who had seen the seamy side of politics in Chicago, about the pressure I was coming under to run for governor and he said I would be crazy to run for office; he said there was no way a man could go into politics without sacrificing his honesty and honor, because no matter how well intentioned he was, a politician was inevitably forced by the realities of political life to compromise.

I said I didn't need any convincing, I wasn't going to run.

The pressure didn't let up. I kept saying no and Holmes Tuttle and his group kept coming back and saying they wouldn't take no for an answer.

It soon got to the point where Nancy and I were beginning to have trouble sleeping at night; the constant emphasis that I was the only guy around who could beat Brown and heal the split in the party put a lot of weight on our shoulders. After a while we'd lie in bed and ask ourselves: *If they're right and things get worse for the party and we could have done something about it, will we ever be able to sleep at night again?*

I finally decided to make an offer to the people who wanted me to run for governor: "Even though I think you're wrong about my being the only Republican who might be able to beat Brown, if you fellows will arrange it for me to go on the road and accept some of the speaking invitations I'm getting from groups around the state, then I'll go out and speak to them and come back in six months, on the last day of 1965, and tell you whether you're right or whether you should be looking for somebody else to run for governor."

I believed that if I continued speaking for six months I'd be able to identify someone whom the people thought would make a good governor, then I'd campaign for him.

Well, my plan worked out that way, but not in the way I expected.